

“Bloodwood”



12+



5-12



30-60 min

GAME RULES:

Introduction:

The game Bloodwood takes you deep into a mystical forest of enigmatic events, where an endless struggle for survival rages among immortal beings. This is a team-based game for 5–12 players — the more participants, the harder and more exciting it becomes to figure out who is friend and who is foe. You will take the role of one of two rival factions: vampires or werewolves. Unlike traditional elimination games, Bloodwood doesn't remove players permanently after a single strike — but you can still inflict irreversible damage, lowering your opponents' chances of victory. Beyond the sinister events of the night and the boons gained during the day, Bloodwood is not just a game of chance dictated by the cards you draw. It is a battle of wit and persuasion: analyzing who stands with you and who stands against you, while using your voice to confuse and mislead your enemies. Nothing stops you from debating, deceiving, or convincing other players to act in your favor.

Objective of the Game:

Winner takes all, loser gets nothing. The only way to end the game is to eliminate the opposing team and declare victory in time. However, there is always the risk of making a mistake — one that could prove fatal and completely change which side claims the win. Details on this are explained further in the rules.

Game Setup:

1. Separate and shuffle the decks. Divide the Night and Day cards into two separate decks and shuffle them. These are the shared draw piles. If a deck runs out, shuffle the discard pile and place it underneath the remaining cards to replenish it. All played cards go face up into the discard pile, placed next to the Day and Night decks.
2. Deal DNA cards. Each player receives one DNA card — one card per player. At the start of the game, all DNA cards must display “Purity”.
3. Place the Phase card. Put the Phase card face up beside the decks. The game always begins in the Day phase.
4. Select Entity cards. Choose the Entity cards according to the number of players. The key rule: teams must be balanced. Example: with 6 players, the split is 3 vs 3, with each team having a leader: Vampires get “Dracula”, Werewolves get “The Alpha”. So for 6 players: deal two “Vampire” plus one “Dracula,” and two “Werewolf” plus one “The Alpha”. If the player count is odd, the larger team does not get a leader. For example: three Vampires versus one Werewolf and one The Alpha (or vice versa). This makes no difference, since no one knows their role beforehand. Shuffle the selected Entity cards and deal them face down — no peeking until the end of the game.

Optional variant: If players agree and numbers allow even teams, the game can be played without Dracula and The Alpha. In this case, no one knows anyone's identity, making the game more challenging and longer.

5. Keep identities secret. Each player must memorize their Entity and keep it hidden until the end of the game.
6. Leader ability (Dracula & The Alpha). Since both leaders have the advantage of seeing all other identities at the start, the following ritual takes place:

One player announces the steps. All players close their eyes. With eyes still closed, each player flips their Entity card face up in their hand. Only the players with Dracula and The Alpha open their eyes and look at the others for a few seconds. They close their eyes again. Everyone flips their cards back to the hidden side. Finally, all players open their eyes. Thus, only Dracula and The Alpha know the teams from the beginning, giving them an advantage. During the game, players may try to convince others about their role or someone else's — telling the truth or lying deliberately — but showing cards is strictly forbidden.

7. Deal starting hands. Each player draws 2 Night cards and 2 Day cards (4 cards total). This is the maximum hand size at the start of a turn.
8. Determine the first player using any convenient method, then place the phase tracker marker next to that player. The game begins.

Goal of the Game:

To figure out who is ally and who is foe, players can rely on the “Blood Test” and “Confession” cards. The objective is to ensure that all members of the opposing team eventually mutate — using tools like the “Bite” and “Curse Mark” cards. Meanwhile, your allies must remain unmutated, aided by cards such as “Vaccine,” “Candle,” and even “Bite.” (Full details are explained in the card descriptions.)



Start of Turn:

The phase countdown begins and continues until all players, in turn order, have taken their turns. Since the game starts in the active Day phase and each player begins with 2 Day cards and 2 Night cards in hand, a player may play only one Day card on their turn. On their turn, a player may choose to completely skip their turn or discard any card from their hand to the discard pile, regardless of whether it is a Day or Night card. If, at the start of a player's turn, they have no cards of the current phase—or no cards at all—they cannot take a turn and proceed directly to the End of Turn step (see details below).

End of Turn:

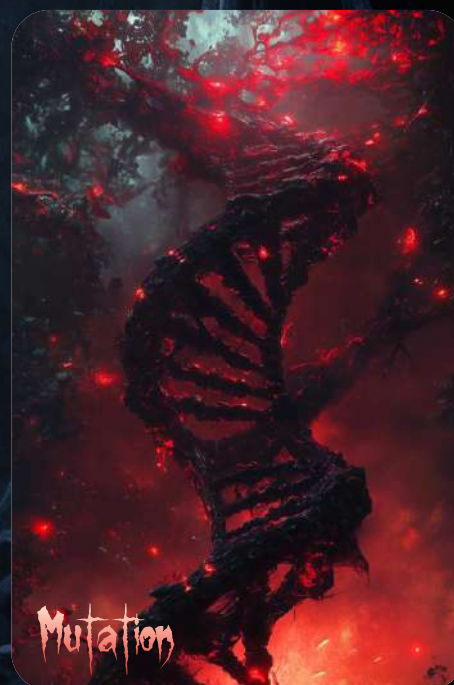
At the end of their turn, the player draws enough cards to bring their hand back up to 4 cards (but never more), unless the card they played specifically blocks this action. The player chooses whether to draw from the Day deck or the Night deck. This decision shapes their options for the next turn, so it's important to analyze the flow of the game and think ahead. There are no restrictions on the ratio of Day to Night cards in hand — it could be 2:2, 3:1, or even 4:0. The only rule is: by the end of the turn, a player may not hold more than 4 cards. Play then passes to the next player on the left. The starting turn order proceeds clockwise.

Phase Change:

Once the last player in the turn order has taken their turn (that is, the player seated next to the one from whom the phase started), the phase switches to its opposite, and the next player must play cards that match the new phase. Certain cards can affect the course of a phase, change it, or reset the phase countdown. These include the “Eclipse” card, which switches the active phase to its opposite and resets the phase countdown, and the “Time Loop” card, which reverses the turn order and also resets the phase countdown. When either of these cards is played, the phase tracker marker moves to the player who played the card (see card descriptions for details).

End of the Game:

This is a critical moment. Any non-mutated player may, at any point during their own turn, declare the end of the game. This action is irreversible. However, the outcome is not yet decided. The player must correctly identify every player on the opposing team, and all of them must be mutated. If the player makes even a single mistake, they and their entire team immediately lose the game, even if they were previously in a winning position. A situation may arise in which all players on one team are mutated, but none of the opponents know this for certain or are confident about all roles. In such a case, the game continues until someone dares to take the risk and end it. If all players in the game are mutated except for one, only that player may declare the end of the game; however, they must still correctly identify the opposing players in order to win.



Phase Card (1 card). The Phase card must remain visible to all players. It indicates the current phase — Day or Night — and is flipped each time the phase changes. Each phase lasts exactly as many turns as there are players in the game. Once every player has taken their turn, the phase switches to the opposite, and the player who began the previous phase also begins the new one. Exceptions are the “Eclipse” and “Time Loop” cards, which can instantly alter the phase and/or reset its cycle. This card may also be used as the phase tracker marker.

DNA Card (12 cards). The DNA card is placed face up for all players to see, next to each player's Entity card. It shows whether a player is in a pure state or mutated, and it is flipped every time a “Bite” card is played on that player. At the start of the game, all players place their DNA card with the “Purity” side facing up. A mutated player cannot declare the end of the game — only a player in a pure state has that right.



“Vampire”

Plays on the same team as other Vampires and Dracula, opposing Werewolves and The Alpha.



“Dracula”

Plays on the same team as other Vampires, opposing Werewolves and The Alpha. At the start of the game, Dracula sees the identities of all other players.



“Werewolf”

Plays on the same team as other Werewolves and The Alpha, opposing Vampires and Dracula.



“The Alpha”

Plays on the same team as other Werewolves, opposing Vampires and Dracula. At the start of the game, The Alpha sees the identities of all other players.



Entity Cards (12 cards)

“Vampire”, “Dracula”, “Werewolf”,
“The Alpha”



Night Cards (68 cards)

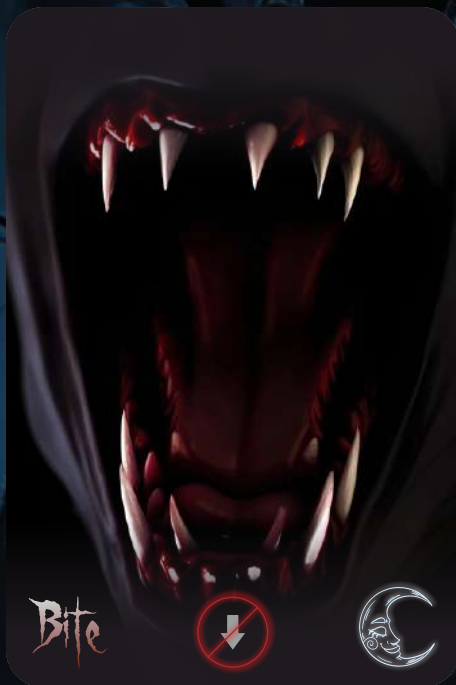
“Bite”, “Curse Mark”, “Chains”,
“Tranquilizer”, “Voodoo”,
“The Leshy”, “The Hunter”, “Mirror”,
“Eclipse”, “Time Loop”



Day Cards (68 cards)

“Vaccine”, “Candle”, “Keys”,
“Pandora’s Box”, “Thief”,
“Blood Test”, “Confession”, “Amulet”,
“Eclipse”, “Time Loop”

Night Cards



“Bite”

Can only be played during the Night phase. Mutates a player’s DNA. If played again on a player who is already mutated, their DNA returns to a pure state. No limit on the number of Bite cards per player per phase. Cannot be played on oneself. Cannot be played on a player who is permanently cursed. The card is immediately placed in the discard pile. The player who plays it then ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 16
Draw probability: 13.33%



“Curse Mark”

Can only be played during the Night phase. A player who receives Curse Mark risks permanent mutation if they fail to discard it within two of their turns. Turns skipped due to Tranquilizer also count. The card can be removed in two ways: Play a Candle on the cursed player, sending Curse Mark to the discard pile. Transfer it to another player using Bite. If a cursed player bites someone or is bitten, Curse Mark passes to the other player, who then has two turns to remove it. A player who fails to remove the card in two turns mutates permanently but remains in the game. They can no longer be targeted by Curse Mark, Bite, or Vaccine. The player flips their DNA card to indicate permanent mutation. Only one Curse Mark may be on a player at a time. The player who plays Curse Mark ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“Chains”

Can only be played during the Night phase. The targeted player keeps Chains next to their Entity and DNA cards, visible to all, until it is discarded. While affected by Chains, the player cannot use Night cards. The card can only be removed using Keys. Only one Chains card may be on a player at a time. The player who plays Chains ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“Tranquilizer”

Can only be played during the Night phase. The targeted player keeps Tranquilizer next to their Entity and DNA cards, visible to all, until their next turn. On their turn, the player skips their action, discards Tranquilizer into the discard pile, and does not draw cards, even if they have fewer than 4. If the player is affected by Curse Mark, the skipped turn counts toward the two-turn limit to remove the curse. Any cards can still be played on a Tranquilized player — they cannot defend themselves, even with Amulet or Mirror. Only one Tranquilizer may be on a player at a time. The player who plays Tranquilizer ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%

Night Cards



“Voodoo”

This card may be played only during the Night phase. The targeted player gives all cards from their hand to the player who played “Voodoo.” That player then chooses which and how many cards to keep from both their own hand and the received cards, and which and how many cards to return to the targeted player. After this redistribution, neither player may have more than 4 cards in hand. This card is immediately placed in the discard pile. No cards are drawn from the deck.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“The Leshy”

Can only be played during the Night phase. Every player except the one who played this card discards 2 cards into the discard pile. The Leshy card is immediately placed in the discard pile. The player who played it ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 4
Draw probability: 3.33%



“The Hunter”

Can only be played during the Night phase. The player discards this card to the discard pile. Each other player gives one card of their choice from their hand to the player who played this card. The player then chooses up to 4 of the received cards and keeps them, discarding the rest. The turn immediately ends, and no cards are drawn from the deck.

Cards per deck: 4
Draw probability: 3.33%



“Mirror”

A defense card. Can only be played as a counter — not on your turn, but in response to a Night card played by an opponent targeting you. Cannot be used to protect another player. Does not work against Day cards. The opponent’s card is reflected back onto them, and they cannot defend using Amulet or Mirror. The Mirror card is immediately placed in the discard pile. No cards are drawn. Cannot be used against The Leshy or The Hunter, as they do not directly target a specific player.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%

*** Optional Rule: Inattention (if agreed by the majority of players):**

If a player intentionally or accidentally breaks the rules — for example, by playing a card out of turn, or playing a card that does not match the current phase or violates any other rules — any player may call them out. In this case, the rule breaker faces a strict penalty: The attempted card is discarded. The player does not draw cards to compensate. The player skips their turn if it was their action.

Day Cards



Vaccine



"Vaccine"

Can only be played during the Day phase. Restores a player's DNA to a pure state, removing any mutation. Can be played on another player. Cannot be used on a player who is permanently cursed. The Vaccine card is immediately placed in the discard pile. The player who played it ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



Candle



"Candle"

Can only be played during the Day phase. Cancels the effect of Curse Mark — both cards are placed in the discard pile. Can be played on another player. The player who played Candle ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



Keys



"Keys"

Can only be played during the Day phase. Cancels the effect of Chains — both cards are placed in the discard pile. Can be played on another player. The player who played Keys ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



Pandora's Box



"Pandora's Box"

Can only be played during the Day phase. The card may be played on yourself or on another player. The targeted player draws 4 cards of their choice from the deck. If, after doing so, the player has more than 4 cards in hand, they must discard the excess cards to the discard pile. The turn immediately ends, and no cards are drawn from the deck.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%

*** Optional Rule: Slowness (if agreed by the majority of players):**

If a player takes too long to decide (as approved by the majority) or exceeds a pre-set turn time for each player, they skip their turn.

Day Cards



“Thief”

Can only be played during the Day phase. The card is immediately placed in the discard pile. The player takes either two random cards from the hand of a single player, or one random card from the hands of two different players, of their choice. If, after the theft, the player has fewer than 4 cards in hand, they draw cards until they have 4. If the player has more than 4 cards in hand, they discard the excess cards to the discard pile.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“Blood Test”

Can only be played during the Day phase. The targeted player reveals their Entity card to the player who played Blood Test. The Blood Test card is immediately placed in the discard pile. The player who played it ends their turn by drawing back up to 4 cards.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“Confession”

Can only be played during the Day phase. It is immediately placed in the discard pile. The targeted player reveals their identity to one other player of their choice. If this card is played again on the same player, they must reveal their identity to a different player of their choice — one to whom they have not previously revealed it. The player who played this card ends their turn by drawing cards until they have 4 cards in hand.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%



“Amulet”

A defense card. Can only be played as a counter — not on your turn, but in response to a Night card played by an opponent targeting you. Cannot be used to protect another player. Does not work against Day cards. Both Amulet and the opponent's card are immediately placed in the discard pile, ending the opponent's action. No cards are drawn. Cannot be used against The Leshy or The Hunter, as they do not directly target a specific player.

Cards per deck: 8
Draw probability: 6.67%

*** Optional Rule: Winner's Privilege (if agreed by the majority of players):**

The player who successfully led their team to victory in the previous game has the right to assign roles for all players in the next game at their discretion. They also determine who takes the first turn.

Special Cards



“Eclipse”

Can be played during any phase. Instantly switches the current phase from Day to Night or vice versa. The new turn starts with the player who played Eclipse. The phase tracker marker moves to the player who played this card. The player draws one card from the deck and takes an additional turn. Cannot play two Eclipse cards consecutively. Eclipse can appear in both the Day and Night decks.

Cards per deck: 2
Draw probability: 1.67%



“Time Loop”

Can be played during any phase. Instantly reverses the turn order. The phase count restarts with the player who played Time Loop. The phase tracker marker moves to the player who played this card. The player draws one card from the deck and takes an additional turn. Cannot play two Time Loop cards consecutively. Time Loop can appear in both the Day and Night decks.

Cards per deck: 2
Draw probability: 1.67%

Number of players: 5-12

Recommended age: 12+

Approximate playtime: 30-60 min

Components: 1 Rulebook; 1 Phase Card; 12 DNA Cards; 12 Entity Cards; 68 Day Cards; 68 Night Cards;

Total number of cards: 161.

Game Author: Max Farmaha, 2024-2025, Made in Ukraine

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Symbols and Notations

Additional symbols next to a card's name are used to simplify the understanding of the card, its effects, and any restrictions.



Day Card. Can only appear in the Day deck.
Can only be played during the Day phase.



Night Card. Can only appear in the Night deck.
Can only be played during the Night phase.



Special Card. Can appear in either the Day or Night deck.
Can be played during any phase.



Defense Card. Can only be played out of turn.
Protects only against Night cards.



Cannot be played on oneself.



Player cannot play Night cards.



Restores a player's DNA to "Purity". Cannot be played on a player who has permanently mutated due to Curse Mark.



Cancels the effect of "Curse Mark". Can only be played on a player holding a Curse Mark card.



Cancels the effect of "Chains". Can only be played on a player holding a Chains card.



Allows the player to draw one card from the deck and take an additional turn.

Online Game Rules:

Scan the QR code with your smartphone and follow the link displayed on the screen:

m-farmaha.github.io/bloodwood/

